TK Project Clips - Clip Launcher

A session view for REAPER. Version 0.6.4 - requires SWS, js_ReaScriptAPI and ReaImGui.

What it is

The Launcher is a view in TK Project Clips, next to Items, Source Media and Automation. It gives you a grid: one lane per track, one row per scene. Clips play in time with your song, on the project's own bar grid, and a launched clip takes over only its own track - every other track keeps playing the arrangement.

How it works

- Every track in your project is a lane, in track order. There is nothing to set up and no separate list to keep in step.
- A lane's clips live on a hidden track that sends into your real track, so a clip is heard through that track's FX chain, EQ and sends. Your own track is never given items.
- That hidden track is made when the lane gets its first clip and removed again when it loses its last, so a project you never launched anything in carries nothing extra.
- Your clips are stored as muted items on the hidden track. They are saved with your project.
- Launching places the clip on the timeline ahead of the play cursor, exactly on the boundary, and mutes that track's arrangement items for as long as the clip owns the track.
- All hidden tracks sit in a folder named TK LAUNCHER, kept at the end of the track list.

Getting started

- Select an item in the arrange view and click an empty slot, or drag a file onto it.
- Click the clip to launch it. Playback starts by itself if the transport is stopped.

Faster: put the edit cursor on a section of your song and press **+ Scene**. Whatever each track is playing there becomes a row.

Filling slots

Source	How
Arrange view	Select one or more items, then click an empty slot. Several items fill consecutive rows.
TK Media Browser / Workbench browser	Drag a file straight onto a slot.
Media Explorer, Windows Explorer	Drag a file onto a slot.
Any file	Right-click a slot, Add file...
The media strip	Drag a row straight onto a slot, or double-click it to let the Launcher pick one.
Items or Source Media view	Right-click a card and choose **Send to launcher**. Several selected items go over together.

Source	How
Nothing at all	Right-click a slot, New empty MIDI clip: one, two, four or eight bars, or as long as the scene it sits in.
Another slot	Alt-drag a clip onto it to move it; hold Ctrl while dropping to copy.
Arrange automation item	Select exactly one automation item, then click an empty slot in the matching automation lane.

Docked or floating both work. If an OS drag never arrives on your system, note that the TK browsers announce what they are dragging themselves rather than relying on one, so that route does not depend on it.

The media strip is a narrow Items and Source Media list beside the grid, switched on under Settings with **Media strip beside the grid**. It is off until you ask for it, because the grid is a lane per track and wants the width; drag the bar between the two to set how much it gets, and that stays. Its two buttons choose which of the lists it shows and its search box is the same one those views use. Hover a row and a triangle appears at its right: that listens to the file, through the same preview engine the clip editor's Play uses, so it touches neither the transport nor the edit cursor and can be used while the grid is running. It needs SWS, and it plays audio, so a MIDI clip has no triangle. Dragging from it is not an OS drag - both halves live in one window - so it works docked as well as floating, and the slot you drop on is the slot it lands in, replacing whatever was there.

Send to launcher, and a double-click in the strip, pick the lane for you instead: the track the clip came from where this project has one by that name, and the selected track otherwise, in the first free row of that lane. An item goes over whole, so it keeps the trim it was given in its own arrange and brings MIDI that exists only inside that project; a Source Media card is a file, and arrives the way a dropped one does, Sync BPM and all. To see other projects at all, Settings has **Include open project tabs** and **Include subprojects** under Project sources.

Either way the Launcher stays a one-project thing: the lanes are this project's tracks, and whatever you put in a slot is copied onto a hidden track here, so nothing ever plays out of another tab. The arrange selection and the automation item route still only see the project you are in, because both of them start from something selected in it.

A clip that was trimmed in the arrange loops the length you trimmed it to, not the whole file. Audio dropped in from a file is stretched to the project tempo when Sync BPM is on, reading the tempo from the file's metadata or its name.

Playing

Action	Mouse	Keyboard
Launch a clip	Click it	Q W E R T Y U I / A S D F G H J K / Z X C V B N M , for the first three rows of the first eight lanes
Launch a scene	Click the row number	1 - 0
Move the outlined cell	Click a cell	Arrow keys
Launch the outlined cell	-	Enter
Stop a lane	Click the lane's stop button	Shift with any of the above
Stop everything	Stop all, or the square beside the bar count in the corner of the grid	Shift + a number key
Empty a slot	Right-click, Clear slot	Delete or Backspace

Clips wait for the next boundary, so they always land in time. An empty slot in a scene means "this track is not part of it" and stops that lane on the same boundary. Ctrl or Alt held means the key is a shortcut, not a clip - Ctrl+Z still undoes.

MIDI control

Open **MIDI Setup** to control clips, scenes and Launcher commands from a MIDI keyboard or pad controller. Switch on **MIDI enabled**, choose the input device, and set the channel to **Omni** or to the one channel your controller sends on. Then pick a layout.

Layout	What it does
Keyboard	Consecutive notes from the Base note across the grid. **Scene per octave** gives each octave a scene; **One octave - active scene** keeps twelve keys on the scene the bank points at.
Pads	A bank of eight. **Clips** puts them on one row of the grid, **Scenes** turns them into eight scene buttons.
Custom Grid	Any number of rows and columns, to match the pads you have. **Lanes across** or **Scenes across** decides which way the grid is read.
Launchpad	An 8 x 8 grid whose rows step by ten or sixteen, with the strip down the right hand side launching scenes - and the pads lit from the grid. See below.

Use **Learn** beside Base note, or beside any command, then play the note or pad you want to assign. A note or CC that is already taken by another command is moved rather than doubled up, so nothing ends up doing two things at once.

Command	What it does
Previous / Next lane bank	Moves the mapping a bank sideways, through the lanes of a project wider than your controller.
Previous / Next scene bank	The same downwards, through the scenes.
Launch active scene	The first scene of the current bank.
Stop active lane	The first lane of the current bank, on the next boundary.
Stop all	Every lane returns to the arrangement on the next boundary.
Record	The same button as in the toolbar: keep what you play instead of clearing it away.
Launch scene 1 to 32	One entry per row, for a controller with buttons to spare.

The bank readout under the layout says which lanes and scenes the controller is on at that moment, so you can see where a bank step has taken you. Holding a pad works too: a clip whose Trigger is **Hold to play** sounds while the pad is held and stops when you let go, exactly as with the mouse. On an armed track, pressing the pad for an empty slot starts recording into that slot; press it again to stop on the nearest bar line.

The MIDI Setup window stays open while you work; close it with the red button or Escape while it has focus. Save the whole setup as a preset to reuse the controller, layout, bank and learned assignments in another session. Presets can be loaded or deleted from the same window.

ReaLearn

ReaLearn support is optional. At the bottom of MIDI Setup, choose **Install Core (8)** for bank navigation, Launch active scene, Stop active lane, Stop all and Record, or **Install Full (40)** to add direct actions for Launch scene 1 to 32. **Remove** takes every TK Project Clips ReaLearn action out of REAPER's Action List again.

After installation, select **REAPER action** as the target in ReaLearn and search the Action List for **TK Project Clips**. Switching between Core and Full replaces the previous set, so no unused scene actions are left behind.

TK Project Clips must be running with the Launcher view active. Commands are queued for the active project and then use the same quantized launch and stop paths as mouse and MIDI control. Stateful actions such as Record and the active scene publish their REAPER toggle state so ReaLearn can use it for feedback where supported.

Launchpad

A Launchpad does not lay its pads out as consecutive notes: its rows step by ten (Mini MK3, X, Pro MK3 and the RGB MK2, pads 11 to 88) or by sixteen (the older S and Mini, 0 to 119). Pick **Launchpad** as the layout and then the family, and the grid follows. **Top left pad** and **A row further down** are there for a board that numbers itself differently; leave them alone and the family decides.

Choose a **MIDI output** and switch on **Light the pads**. On Windows the port a DAW is meant to use is the second one, usually called MIDIOUT2. From then on the grid shows what the launcher knows: an empty slot is dark, a filled one glows in its clip's colour, the clip that is playing pulses on the beat, one waiting for its bar line blinks, and an armed track blinks red. Press a blinking red pad to record into that slot, then press it again to stop. The strip on the right lights for scenes that have something in them. Learned command notes and CCs glow dimly, flash when pressed, and become bright while actions such as Record are active. Only pads that change colour are sent, so the board keeps up.

Mode decides how much of the board the Launcher takes over, and MK3 boards give you the choice:

- **DAW mode** switches on the Session layout and lights the Session button, which is what Ableton and PlayTime do. Select the Launchpad's dedicated DAW input in **Connection** and its matching DAW output under the Launchpad settings; on Windows these are commonly the second MIDI ports. The regular MIDI port remains available for playing an instrument. This is the default. In this mode the strip on the right sends and receives control changes rather than notes, which the Launcher handles for you.
- **Programmer mode** hands the whole surface over. Novation's own reference is blunt about the cost: while it is on, the board's Setup entry is disabled and it only returns to normal operation when it is switched back. Use it only if DAW mode will not talk to your board.

Either way the mode is sent when the lights go on and undone when the Launcher closes; **Send mode again** asks a second time, for a board that was unplugged and put back.

Everything that moves on the board is driven from the project's own beat: a clip waiting for its bar line blinks, one that is playing pulses, an armed slot blinks red, and they all do it on the same line, in step with the same blinking in the grid on screen. The RGB boards can flash and pulse in hardware and earlier versions used that, but a board runs those on its own clock - 120 BPM unless it is fed MIDI clock - so at any other tempo its pads beat against the rest. With the transport stopped the blink keeps to the tempo under the edit cursor, so an armed slot waiting to record is already in time before you press play.

An S or a Mini MK1 has only red and green lamps, so on those the colour is the state rather than the clip's own colour: dark, green, amber, red.

Test pattern paints the grid in a known order - row 1 red, then orange, yellow, green, cyan, blue, purple, white, with the left half bright and the right half dim - so that what you see says whether the top left pad, the row step and the colours are right on your board.

What a click does

Each clip decides for itself, under **Trigger** in its right-click menu.

Trigger	What a second click does
Click starts, click stops	Stops it on the next bar line. This is the default.
Click starts, click restarts	Fires it again from the top.
Hold to play	There is no second click: the clip plays while the mouse is held and stops the moment you let go.

Hold to play stops on the beat you release, not on the next bar line, so it is a gate rather than a launch. That needs an effect in the signal path, because a clip is already written onto the timeline and buffered by the time you let go. The Launcher writes a small JSFX called **TK Clip Gate**, installs it, and puts it on the lanes that need one. Lanes with no held clip never get it, and it is taken off again when the last one is changed back.

An automation clip needs none of that: there is no sound to shut, so the curve simply ends where you let go and the parameter falls back to the track's own envelope. Let go before the bar line and the launch is cancelled outright rather than playing a sliver of itself.

Clip options

Right-click any clip. The menu is grouped: what to do with it now, when it plays, how it sounds, what it is called, what is in it, and getting it out.

Option	What it does
Launch / Stop lane	The same as clicking, from the menu.
Trigger	See above.
Loop clip	On: the clip repeats. Off: it plays once.
When it has played / Play Nx	Follow action: after N rounds it hands over. **Next scene** is the row straight below, empty or not - a lane with nothing there sits that scene out, and sitting one out means stopping. **Next scene with a clip** walks past the empty rows instead, and round to the top when there is nothing below. Then the previous scene, the first, a random row this lane has filled, itself, or stop. Nothing happens while the **Follow actions** switch is off; the menu says so and offers to switch it back on.
Retrigger every	For one-shots: fires the clip on a grid from 1/16 to 2 bars. Below the divisions you can switch individual steps of the bar on and off, so a snare can sit on 2 and 4. Steps are anchored to the project grid, so the pattern lands the same way whenever you start it.
Gain	Level for this clip, adjustable while it plays. It sits before the track's FX.
Speed	0.25x to 2x, in six steps. Pitch is preserved. The setting multiplies whatever rate the clip already had, so tempo matching still holds.
Tempo	Stretched to the project, or played at its own recorded speed.
Key	For MIDI clips: what key the Launcher thinks it is in, and what to do about it. See Session key.

Option	What it does
Rename / Colour	A name and colour of your own. The cell, its waveform and its play marker follow the colour; without one the clip uses the track colour.
Edit clip...	For audio clips: the wave editor below.
Edit in MIDI editor	Opens a MIDI clip in REAPER's editor. Its lane is shown for as long as the editor is open, because an action will not touch an item on a track it cannot see. The cell picture follows the notes as you change them.
Replace with selected item / with file...	Swap the clip without clearing the slot first.
Write clip to arrangement at cursor	See Getting clips into the arrangement.
Clear slot	Empties it. If that was the lane's last clip, its hidden track goes too.

Editing a clip

Edit clip... in an audio clip's menu opens a window on the file behind it: its waveform with a grid over it, the part that plays marked out, and the fades drawn as the ramps they are. It closes with the red button or Escape. It is a window of its own rather than a popup, so clicking elsewhere in REAPER leaves it alone: drag it by its background to place it, and it comes back where you left it, this session and the next.

Control	What it does
Start / End	Which part of the file the clip is, as two points, side by side under the waveform. Drag the lines in the waveform to move them, or these sliders - the same thin groove and knob as the fader in a lane header, so drag sets and a double click puts it back to the end of the file it belongs to. Both snap the same way. The distance between them is the loop length, so a two bar loop is two bars because you put the points there.
Fade in / Fade out	Up to half the clip each. A clip with no fade of its own still gets the few milliseconds the launcher puts on every voice to cover a cut mid waveform. Stopping a lane fades into the bar line it stops on, so the fade is heard without the stop arriving any later.
Fade every pass	A loop is one item with the source going round inside it, so its fades are heard on the way in and on the way out of the whole thing - the same as one looping item in the arrange. Switch this on and every round gets both, by laying the loop down a pass at a time. Only offered once a fade is set. With it on, **Play** gives you a single pass rather than a rolling loop: the preview engine lays its fades at the start and the end of playing rather than on every round, and one pass is exactly what every round of the clip will sound like.
Gain	The same level as in the clip menu, with the waveform beside it.
Speed	The same 0.25x to 2x, pitch preserved.
Pitch	Up or down in semitones without changing the speed, which is the shift a sampler gives you. It sits on the clip's take, so voices and anything written to the arrangement carry it.
Reverse	Plays the part between the markers backwards. It is the same section on the source, only turned round, so nothing is written into the audio. The whole picture turns with it: the file is drawn right to left, which keeps the peaks still while you drag the markers over them, and playback still reads left to right because the end of the clip is now the left hand edge. A small arrow says **reversed** in case the shape alone is not obvious.

Control	What it does
Play / Stop	Hears the part between the markers, at the clip's speed, level, pitch and fades, through the lane's own track so the FX chain is on it. It uses SWS's preview engine, so it touches neither the transport, nor the edit cursor, nor anything that is muted - and a line runs across the waveform to show where it is. Trim while it plays and it picks up the new bounds; speed, level, pitch and fades reach the running preview as you change them.
Snap	Bars, beats, half or quarter beats, or off. The grid is the project's own, stretched by the rate the clip plays at, so a bar line in the window is a bar line when it sounds.
Only the part that plays	Switches the view between the whole file and the clip with a little air around it.

Fade in, fade out, gain and pitch are knobs: drag up and down, hold ctrl for fine, and double-click one to put it back to nothing. Nothing is written into the audio. Start and length become a section on the source, the way a clip trimmed in the arrange already arrives, and the fades and the level belong to the clip itself. That matters for where it ends up: every voice and every write to the arrangement copies that same clip, so what you set here is what plays **and** what lands in the arrange when you drag it out or write a scene.

A clip that is playing at that moment keeps what it had - it is already on the timeline. The next launch has the edit.

Normalise sets the gain so the loudest point between the markers reaches 0 dB - it measures the peaks that are already read for the picture and moves the gain slider, so the audio is untouched and the way back is that same slider. **Whole file** gives the clip the file back, **No fades** clears both, and **Open in REAPER** shows the lane tracks with this clip selected, for the editing a window this size should not try to do.

Recording into a slot

An empty slot can record what you play, the way a session view does. You need the track armed in REAPER first - the Launcher will tell you if it is not.

- Arm the track, then click the record circle on the empty slot. The transport starts if it was stopped.
- You get a count-in: recording punches in on the launch quantize, not on your click, so you have the same bar of run-up you would get launching a clip.
- Play.
- Click again to stop. Recording ends on the nearest bar line rather than the next one, because stopping is a reaction and the click lands a moment after the bar you meant to be your last.
- The clip appears in the slot by itself.

Right-click the slot and choose **Cancel recording into this slot** to call it off before it punches in. One lane records one thing at a time; starting a second slot on the same lane ends the first, and the two meet on the line with no gap.

The take is left on the arrangement as well, so you can keep it as an ordinary recording. Switch on **Clear the take after recording** in the settings and it is removed once the slot has its clip - the audio itself stays on disk either way.

Scenes

A row is a section of your song. The number beside it is its length in bars, taken from the longest clip in the row rounded up; shorter clips loop to fill it. Right-click the row number for:

- **When it has played / Play Nx** - the same follow actions, one level up: the whole row moves on together.

- **Write this scene only, at cursor** - puts the row into the arrangement at the edit cursor, each clip on its own track. The cursor parks at the end, so scenes can be chained by hand.
- **Write the whole chain from here...** - walks the follow actions without playing them and writes the result, bounded by a length in bars you give.
- **Fill scene from arrangement at cursor** - the reverse: fills that row from what your tracks play there.

The **Follow actions** switch turns them off without clearing what they are set to - useful while building. A random follow action rolls the dice once when written, so you can generate a version, listen, and write again if you do not like it.

One row more and **One row fewer** change how many scenes the grid has.

Lane headers

Each lane header carries its track's name and colour, and a row of controls.

Control	What it does
Stop	Stops that lane on the next boundary.
S	Solo. This is REAPER's own solo on the real track, so it behaves the way solo does everywhere else.
A	Mutes that track's arrangement by hand, whether or not a clip is playing. Turn it off while a clip runs and you hear both layered.
FX	What the track already has, and a way to add more. At the top of the menu is the FX on that track: click one to open it in its own window, right-click one to bypass it without closing the menu. Below that: your TK FX Browser folders first, then Category, Developer, Folders, All plugins, Favorites, Recent and FX chains. The badge counts the effects on the track; right-click the badge itself for the chain.
Fader	The track's volume, if **Volume in the lane header** is on and the row is tall enough. It lets you collapse the track panel out of the way and still mix.

Clicking the header selects the track. Right-click it for **Reset volume to 0 dB**, **Select target track**, **Name to look for in another project...** and **Clear this lane's clips**.

Working alongside your arrangement

Control	Effect
Launching a clip	Silences that track's arrangement for as long as the clip owns the track.
Mute song	Silences the whole arrangement while the clips keep playing. It mutes the items, not the tracks - muting a track would kill the clip too, because the clip arrives on a send. On by default; the choice is remembered per project.
Reset everything	Everything back at once: clips stopped, every muted item restored, song mute off. Playback keeps rolling. This is the recovery button - it reports how many items it put back.

Recording a performance

Nothing is rendered. What you get are ordinary items pointing at the same media, at the positions where you played them, with the lengths and cuts you performed.

- Put the edit cursor where the take should start. An arrangement loop is fine: the take is gathered from what was actually written, not from a window of time.
- Press Record. The count on the button includes clips still sounding.
- Play. Clips, scenes and follow actions are all captured.
- Press it again to stop. The take finishes the current bar and everything in it is trimmed to that line. Press once more to cut it off immediately instead.
- **Keep** moves the take onto your real tracks; **Discard** throws it away. The arrangement it replaced stays muted, so what you kept is what you heard.

An undecided take is discarded when the script closes. Keep is a single undo step.

Getting clips into the arrangement

- Alt-drag a clip from the grid onto the arrange view. The edit cursor follows the snapped landing point while you drag, and the target track and bar are shown at the bottom of the window.
- Right-click a clip: **Write clip to arrangement at cursor**.
- Right-click a scene number to write that row, or the whole chain.

Timing settings

Behind the **Timing** button, which shows the current quantize in its label.

Setting	What it is
Launch quantize	The boundary clips wait for: off, one beat, or a fraction or multiple of a bar up to eight. The bar settings count the measures REAPER itself draws, so a time-signature change part way through the song cannot push the grid off the bar lines.
Clip run-up	How far ahead a clip is put on the timeline before it plays. REAPER reads media ahead of the play cursor and does not go back for anything that appears inside that window, so a clip given too little run-up loses the start of its own audio. A launch that cannot make the deadline waits for the next boundary instead of arriving damaged. Auto derives it from your media buffer and is the right choice for almost everyone.
Media buffer	REAPER's own setting, shown here because it decides the run-up. Smaller means you can launch closer to the beat; larger is safer on a slow disk or a heavy project. It does not affect latency. This is a global REAPER preference, and the panel can put back the value it had before the Launcher ever changed it.

The run-up is also how close to the line you may click and still make it: click inside it and the launch takes the next boundary instead. It never goes below 0.3 seconds, whatever you set.

If a clip comes in late, raise the run-up one step. If launches too often slip to the next bar, lower your media buffer rather than the run-up.

Layout

In the settings window, under Launcher.

Setting	What it does
Scenes as columns	Turns the grid on its side, a lane per row and a scene per column, the way Bitwig lays it out. Clips keep their size.
Lane height follows the track	Gives each lane row the height REAPER gives its track, so the grid lines up with the track panel beside it. Envelope lanes under a track are counted, and the clip row fills that whole height.
Line up with the first track	Grows the header row until the first lane starts where its track does, so changing the ruler height does not put the two out of step. It can only add space; where the grid starts below the track, fold this window's own bars away instead.
Scroll with the arrange	Scrolling the arrange scrolls the grid to the same track.
and the arrange with the grid	The other way as well. Leave it off and the Launcher never moves your arrange by itself.
Colour lane headers	Fill each header with its track's colour instead of a stripe down its left edge.
Volume in the lane header	See Lane headers.

The three lower settings need **Scenes as columns**, where a lane is a row and there is a track beside it to line up with.

The caret in the grid corner folds this window's own chrome away: title bar and toolbar, title bar only, toolbar only, or neither. **Waveform cells** draws each clip in its cell; turn it off for a compact grid of names only.

Clip sets

The grid, your clips and their settings are saved with the project. A clip set saves them to a file instead, so the same rig can be loaded into another project.

Behind **Clip sets...**: **Save set...**, **Load a file...**, and a library organised in folders, one per production. Sets are matched to tracks by name; **Create missing tracks on load** makes the ones that are not there. Use **Name to look for in another project...** on a lane header where the track is called something else.

Session key

The Launcher can read what key a MIDI clip is in - from its metadata, its file name, its folder, or the notes themselves - and fit clips to a key you set for the project.

- **This project works in:** sets the session key and mode. Clips outside it are marked.
- **Map the scale degrees** moves each note to the nearest degree of the session scale. **Transpose to the root only** shifts the whole clip instead, leaving its own mode intact.
- **Fit clips on import** does it as clips arrive; **Fit every clip now** does the lot in one go.
- Per clip, the **Key** submenu shows what was read and lets you correct it, send the clip **Back to its own key**, or **Read the key from its notes** again.

Transposed clips are marked in the grid, and the clip menu names the chords it found.

Chord follow

Chord follow lets a MIDI clip follow a chord progression while it plays or is written to the arrangement. Open **Guide**, choose a **MIDI chord guide track**, then right-click the clip and choose **Chord follow**. The guide track may contain ordinary MIDI chord notes; **Create/update chord items** adds optional labelled items showing the chords the Launcher recognized.

- **Root** transposes each note by the shortest interval from the clip's detected root to the guide chord root at that point in time.
- **Scale degree** moves the notes by the corresponding degree of the session scale. This needs a session key and keeps the movement diatonic to that scale.
- **Off** leaves the clip unchanged.

Chord follow is applied to MIDI clips when they are launched, retriggered or written. It is separate from **Fit clips on import**: session-key fitting adapts a clip once to the project key, while chord follow responds to each chord along the timeline. The clip needs a known root under **Key**; audio clips are not transposed.

Automation

A view of its own, beside the Launcher. It lists every automation item pool in the project as a card: the curve, its name, where it is used, how many instances there are, and its position and length in bars. Track and take envelopes both.

Double-click a card to go to its first instance. Right-click for **Insert at edit cursor** (pooled or unpooled), **Insert on another envelope**, **Select every instance**, **Go to** any instance by name, and a field to rename the pool.

Automation clips

A clip can be a curve instead of a sound. Launching one puts an automation item on an envelope of that lane's track, on the same bar line every other clip lands on. Stopping the lane takes it away again and the parameter goes back to whatever the track's own automation says.

Curves do not sit in the track's lane. Each parameter gets a lane of its own underneath it, the way the arrange puts envelope lanes under a track, so a curve can run while the track's clip keeps playing. Their heights follow the matching envelope lanes in the arrange when **Lane height follows the track** is on.

Making one	How
From a track lane	Right-click an empty cell, **New automation clip**, pick Volume, Pan or the plugin parameter you last touched, then a length. The lane is made for you and the clip lands in it.
From an automation lane	Right-click an empty cell, **New automation clip** and a length. The parameter is the one that lane is on. Clicking an empty cell makes a flat clip at the envelope's current value straight away.
An empty lane first	Right-click a lane header, **Add automation lane**.
From REAPER's own	**From an automation item**: the AutomationItems folder in your resource path, subfolders and all. The file says how long it is, so a four bar sweep arrives as a four bar clip.

Making one	How
From the arrange	Select exactly one automation item and click the plus in an empty slot of the lane for that same envelope. Its points, shapes, tension and length come with it. The Launcher says so when nothing is selected, when more than one is, or when the item belongs to another envelope.

Edit curve... puts the clip on its envelope at the edit cursor, makes that envelope visible in a lane of its own and scrolls to it, so you draw with REAPER's own tools. **Curve done** takes the points back into the clip - including a length you changed by dragging the item's edge - and clears it out of the arrange. **Cancel** leaves the clip as it was. Both sit in the toolbar and in the clip's own menu, because the toolbar can be folded away.

Save as automation item... writes the curve into REAPER's AutomationItems folder, so a shape built here can be dropped on any envelope in any project and picked up again by **Load automation item**.

A curve is stored with its clip as the Launcher's own data - times as a fraction of the clip, values from 0 to 1 - rather than as a REAPER pool. That is what lets **Point at** send the same clip to another parameter, and what makes it stretch when you give the clip more bars or change the tempo.

What launches what

- Launching a track clip starts the curves in its own row with it.
- Launching a curve moves only that lane to that row. The track keeps playing what it played, and so do the other automation lanes.
- **Follow parent clip** on a lane header switches the first of those off, so that lane only answers to its own cells.
- The square button on an automation lane header pauses it. Press it again, or launch one of its slots, to resume.
- Stopping a track stops its curves with it. Stopping one automation lane leaves the rest alone.
- A launch only ever starts things. Move a track to a row where an automation lane has nothing and that curve keeps running - stopping is something you ask for.

Trigger, Loop clip, When it has played, Play Nx, Rename, Colour, Write clip to arrangement and Clear slot all work as they do for any clip, and so does Hold to play. Gain, Speed, Tempo, Key, Chord follow and Retrigger are for media and are hidden. Automation clips travel in clip sets like anything else: the curve goes with the file and loading it back builds the lane again, though a clip is skipped if the plugin it points at is not on the track in the new project.

Housekeeping

- **Show the lane tracks** reveals the hidden tracks in the arrange for a look; they stay out of the mixer.
- The grid, your clips and all their settings are saved with the project. Nothing is written to disk until you save.
- Files dropped in are referenced, not copied. Use REAPER's own "copy media into project folder" if you want the project self-contained.
- A clip whose media is gone, or a lane whose track was deleted, is marked in red and refuses to launch. Neither is removed automatically, because undoing the deletion brings it back.

Known limits

- No warping. Clips do not follow tempo changes the way Ableton's do; tempo matching happens once, when a file is brought in.

- The media strip is fed by the same scan the Items view runs, so leaving it open keeps that scan going while you play. It skips the once-a-second check for missing media, which is the expensive half; a file that goes missing while the strip is open is noticed when you next leave the Launcher.
- A clip taken from another project tab is copied into this one and belongs to it from then on. Send what you want while that tab is open: once it is closed its items leave the lists, and only audio can still be added afterwards, by its file. MIDI that existed only inside that project cannot.
- At fast tempos, when a bar is shorter than the run-up, a launch lands a boundary later than you clicked.
- Empty MIDI clips are a whole number of bars. There is no loop brace to drag a clip's length by hand.
- An automation clip is a whole number of bars too. A file whose own length is not one is rounded to the nearest bar and its curve stretched to fit.
- The keyboard grid addresses track lanes only. Automation lanes are mouse work.
- A curve launched inside a loop region starts where you launched it on every pass; media fills the stretch before it, automation does not.
- Where a curve lands on an envelope that already carries automation items of its own, the Launcher leaves those alone rather than trimming them out of the way.